

FORGE.

GROUP ADMIN GUIDE

1 — What You Own

As a Forge group admin, you own three things: the **Google Sheet** (all match and player data), the **GAS backend** (the script that powers your group), and the **group password**. Forge manages the app itself — you never need to touch the code on GitHub.

YOU CONTROL	FORGE CONTROLS
Google Sheet data	The app at forgepickle.github.io
Group password	Rating algorithm and analytics
GAS deployment	Central registry (group lookup)
Who can join (by sharing the link and password)	Premium / Alpha feature access

2 — Your Google Sheet at a Glance

Your sheet has six tabs. Forge manages all data through the app — you rarely need to open the sheet directly. The exceptions are noted below.

TAB	WHAT IT CONTAINS	WHAT YOU CAN TOUCH
<code>CONFIG</code>	Group settings: password, rating parameters, app config keys	Safe to edit: the value in column B for the <code>password</code> key. Never add or delete rows.
<code>PLAYERS</code>	One row per player. Ratings, game counts, match history snapshots	Managed by Forge. You may manually edit <code>starting_rating</code> for a player who joins at a custom rating — run Recalculate via the Admin Panel afterward.
<code>MATCHES</code>	Full match history. Last 500 are served to the app; all are kept for record	Never delete rows manually. Use the in-app delete function — it replays ratings correctly. Manual row deletion will corrupt player ratings.
<code>SESSIONS</code>	Single-row store for the live shuffle session	Do not touch. Managed entirely by the app. Auto-created on first session save.
<code>REQUESTS</code>	Write idempotency log — prevents duplicate match submissions	Ignore. Auto-trimmed to 500 rows.
<code>ADMIN_LOG</code>	Audit trail of admin logins and data exports	Read-only. Never delete rows.

CONFIG KEYS REFERENCE

KEY (COLUMN A)	WHAT IT DOES	DEFAULT
password	Group login password. Change this before sharing the link.	password
starting_rating	DUPR rating assigned to new players	3.50
k_factor	Rating swing magnitude per match	32
k_scale	Per-point delta normaliser	30
admin_pw	Separate password for the Admin Panel (7-tap unlock)	Set by you
premium_main	Enables Forge Alpha analytics. Set by Forge — do not edit.	0

3 — Day-to-Day Admin Tasks

SHARE THE GROUP LINK

On the Forge password screen, tap the lime Group ID pill to copy the full link. Share the link and the password with players. The link format is `https://forgepickle.github.io/app/?group=XXXXXX`.

CHANGE THE PASSWORD

Open your Google Sheet → `CONFIG` tab → find the row where column A says `password` → edit the value in column B. Takes effect immediately. No redeployment needed. Share the new password with your group.

COMMON IN-APP TASKS

Add a player	Players screen → tap the + icon in the header
Remove a player	Players screen → tap the player → Edit → Remove Player. Their history is preserved; they are marked inactive.
Reinstate a player	Players screen → show Inactive → tap player → Reinstate
Log a match	Tap the + nav button → follow the 5-step Add Match wizard
Delete a wrong match	Matches screen → tap the match → Delete. Ratings replay automatically. Do not delete rows in the sheet directly.
Clear a stuck session	Tap the Active Session button → Session View → Delete Session in the footer

Never delete MATCHES rows in Google Sheets. Always use the in-app delete. Manual deletion skips the ratings replay and leaves player ratings in an incorrect state.

4 — The Admin Panel

The Admin Panel is a hidden screen for admin-only operations. It is not visible in the normal navigation.

HOW TO ACCESS

- 1 Go to the **Matches** screen
- 2 Tap the **MATCHES** header title 7 times in quick succession
- 3 Enter your admin password (`admin_pw` from the CONFIG tab)

Once unlocked, the panel stays open for the session. It closes on logout.

EXPORT DATA

Copies all player and match data to a separate Google Sheet. Use this for backups or external reporting. The destination sheet must be configured once before the export function will work.

One-time backup sheet setup

- 1 Go **sheets.new** to create a new blank Google Sheet. Name it something like *Forge Backup — [Your Group Name]*.
- 2 Copy the `/d/` and `/edit` in the address bar. Example: `https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/1aBcDeFgHiJkLmNoPqRsTuVwXyZ/edit`
- 3 Open your **CONFIG** tab → find the row where column A says `export_sheet_id` → paste the Sheet ID into column B.

- 4 Open **Export** . `FORGE_PLAYERS` and `FORGE_MATCHES` tabs in the **Data** Forge Admin Panel will create backup sheet and copy all data across. → tap

Each export overwrites the previous backup. Run it before major changes or on a regular schedule.

5 — Updating Your Backend (Code.gs)

When a new Forge version requires a backend update, a yellow banner appears in the app saying "*Your group's backend needs updating.*" You will also receive an update email at your registered admin email address containing the new Code.gs script.

Check your email first. The update email contains the full new Code.gs text. Copy it from there.

UPDATE STEPS

- 1 Open your Google Sheet → **Extensions** → **Apps Script**
- 2 Select all existing code in the editor and delete it
- 3 Paste the new Code.gs from the update email
- 4 Click **Save** (floppy disk icon or Ctrl+S)
- 5 Click **Deploy** → **Manage deployments**
- 6 Click the **pencil icon** next to your existing deployment
- 7 Under Version, select **New version**
- 8 Click **Deploy**

Use Manage Deployments — not New Deployment. Editing your existing deployment keeps the same URL. If you click "New deployment" instead, a new URL is generated and your group will stop working. If this happens, email `forge.pickle@gmail.com` with your Group ID and the new URL.

6 — Troubleshooting

SYMPTOM	LIKELY CAUSE	FIX
"Group not found" on app load	Missing or wrong <code>group=</code> URL param	Use the full group link: <code>forgepickle.github.io/app/?group=XXXXXX</code> . Check the Group ID is correct.
App spins for several seconds after login	GAS cold start (normal after ~6 min idle)	Wait up to 8 seconds and retry. This is a Google platform limitation and cannot be eliminated.
"Backend unreachable" error	GAS deployment issue or wrong URL in registry	Open your GAS project and confirm the deployment is active. If the URL changed, email <code>forge.pickle@gmail.com</code> .
Player ratings look wrong	A match was manually deleted from the sheet, or data was edited directly	Use the Admin Panel to recalculate ratings. Contact Forge if the panel is not available.
Same match logged twice	Double submission or two players logged the same court	Tap the duplicate in the Matches screen and delete it. Ratings replay automatically.
Active session stuck or won't clear	Session was not ended cleanly	Tap the Active Session button → Session View → Delete Session in the footer.
Version banner keeps reappearing	Code.gs has not been updated	Follow the update steps in Section 5. Banner dismisses per session but reappears until the backend is updated.

For issues not listed here, email `forge.pickle@gmail.com` with your Group ID and a description of the problem.